

Hello, in this section, we will be talking about time management, how to maintain your time with everything regarding your academics, extracurricular activities, and general social life. Make sure to click on the video or read the article posted below for more information. (example)

First off, what is time management? This concept seeks to explain how to organize and plan your time so you can achieve your important tasks without feeling overwhelmed.

Let's go through some examples!

Example 1: High school student

This high school student wakes up around 6 am and leaves school around 2 pm, after this, he has a set organizer that has all of his tasks for the day (ex, go to practice, workout, finish schoolwork). By having this organized, he can decide the times where he can work. If he has practice after school, he can work on his schoolwork AFTER his practice, being efficient with his time.

Example 2: Student with family responsibilities

Well, people may have different lives, so what about people who have to take care of their siblings? They would benefit from time management, studying or doing work whenever they have free time. They can also sort their homework into chunks, doing these chunks day by day. By doing this, they can take care of their siblings, and work, without the need to multitask.

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

Good time management can lead to:

- Meeting deadlines
- Reduced Stress
- Proper Sleep
- Improvement in grades
- Time for social activities
- Avoidance of last minute cramming

Poor time management can lead to

- Piling up of assignments
- Feeling overwhelmed
- Burnout
- Worse academic performance

If you invest time in time management, it can affect your college admissions, since it directly correlates with your grades, time for extracurricular activities, and demonstration of a social aspect of your life (like volunteering).

While time management seems like its common sense, many do not practice efficient management methods. Developing these habits can help you in the long run, so it's key to understand how to. Let's take a look at efficient ways to manage your time:

First I will guide you through 5 steps to successfully manage your time:

## 1. Write everything down!

Make sure to write everything down that is mandatory to finish and or in the process of completing. You can organize by sorting through academics, extracurriculars, etc.

Here are some resources to help you organize your work

1. Notion (great use of templates for this) (we can link this one template I have )
2. Google calendar ( Very simple, and is linked to your google account)
3. A physical planner ( Great option if you enjoy physical items)
4. A simple notebook ( create a checklist)
5. Apple calendar ( Good in-between)

## 2. Prioritize your tasks.

See, writing it down was the easiest part, however what you do past that can be just as important.

Make sure to organize your tasks based on urgency, what needs to be done, when.

For example you can list it as

1. Urgent
2. Important, not urgent
3. Later work

## 3. Break down assignments

A common mistake is grouping assignments into one overarching task. A good way to organize certain tasks that are large, is to break it down into smaller tasks.

By doing this, you can gradually finish the task without it feeling overwhelming.

For example, rather than writing “research paper”

You can say

1. Find sources
2. Create the general outline
3. Write intro
4. Finish body paragraphs
5. Finish conclusion

Much better!

## 4. Schedule Study Times

Of course, at some point, you will have tests and quizzes, so a good option is to schedule your study times. By doing this, you can have set times to focus on learning the material before the upcoming test/quiz.

Example:

“Ok so Monday:

4:30-5:30- Study for Algebra 2

5:30-6:30- Study for English

Tuesday:

“Maybe a bit later?”

6:30-8:00- Study for World History

While this is just an example, study routines are a great way to organize your time, since it allows you to learn the concepts in chunks, rather than all at once.

## 5. Reduce Distractions

While doing all this, make sure to turn the phone off.

1. Silence notifications
2. Put your phone across the room
3. Close distracting tabs
4. Study in a quiet environment.

Next, let's talk about the pros and cons of different time management planners

| Strategy                                              | Pros                                  | Cons                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Paper planner                                         | Simple, no distractions               | Easy to forget                               |
| Digital calendar                                      | Sends reminders, syncs across devices | Requires checking your phone/computer        |
| To-do lists                                           | Easy to organize tasks                | Doesn't show when to do them                 |
| Time blocking                                         | Helps build routines                  | Can feel restrictive                         |
| Pomodoro Technique (25 minutes work, 5 minutes break) | Improves focus and prevents burnout   | Doesn't work well for everyone or every task |

Finally here are some more resources and tips to get started!

Tips to get started:

1. Start with a planner of your choice!
2. Spend 5-10 minutes organizing all your work into the planner
3. Review your schedule every Sunday
4. Prioritize your top 3 most important tasks every week(still do the other ones)
5. Leave yourself enough time that if anything unexpected happens, you still can finish your work.
6. The day is not set for you, so don't expect it to go as planned, move on and finish the work.

Here are some resources for you!

Google Calendar — for scheduling classes, activities, and reminders.

Notion — for organizing assignments, notes, and long-term projects.

Microsoft To Do — for simple task management.

Onrise: A great, simple way to organize your tasks, however is a bit restrictive(based on personal experience)